

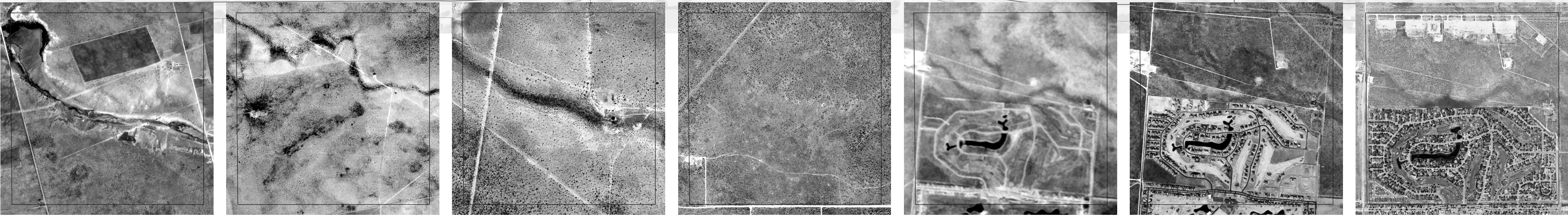
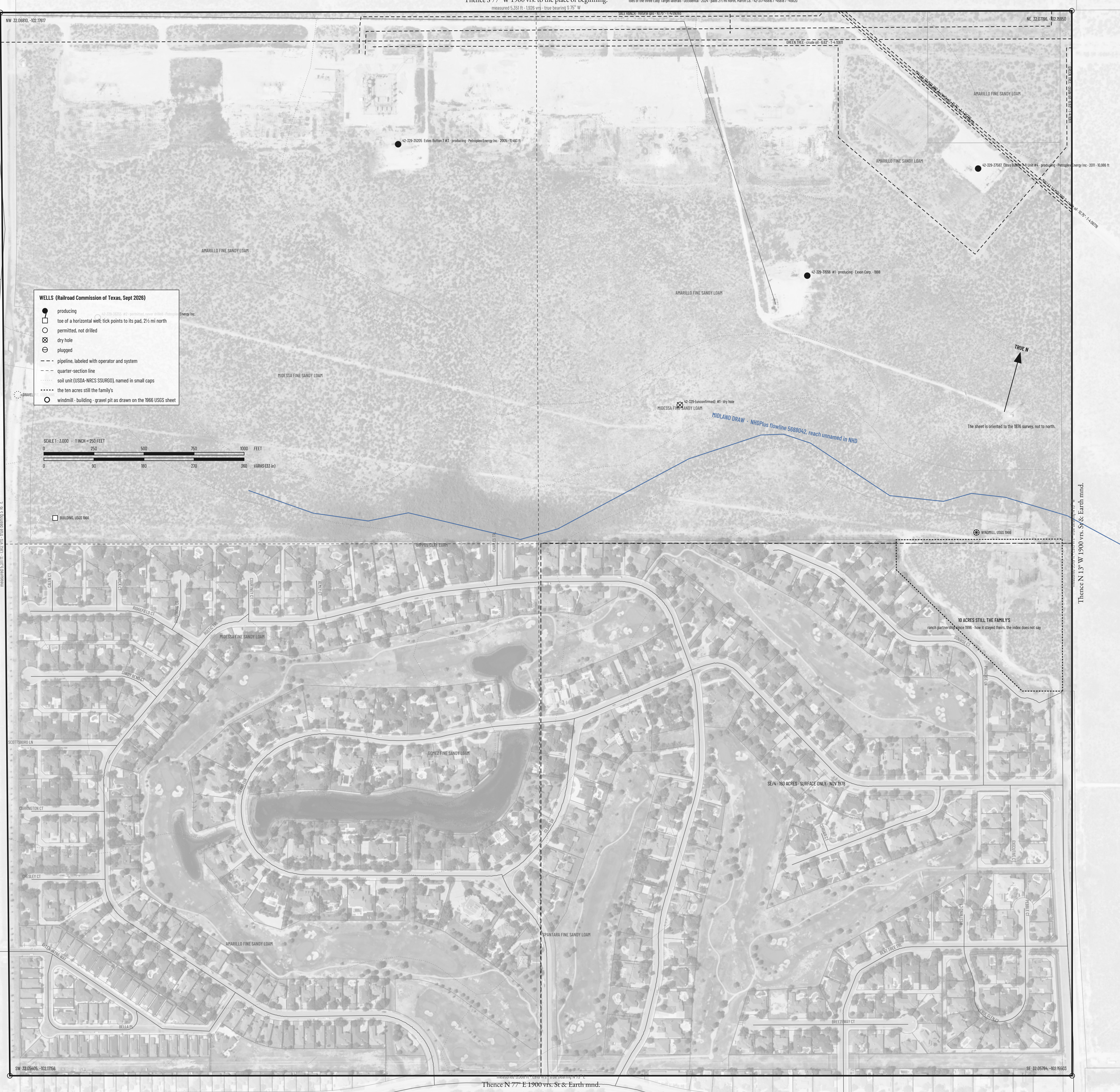
SECTION 7

Block 39, Township 1 South, Texas & Pacific Railway Company Survey · Abstract 34 · Midland County, Texas

ONE SQUARE MILE *Desk Edition. Compiled from records, not walked.*

First edition, October 2026. One copy. Corrections invited; anyone who corrects it gets the second edition free.

Beginning at a stake & Earth mound, 4 pits, the S.W. corner of Survey No. 6



1946 USGA, 20 Feb 1946, two frames mosaicked. Range, one field, a full plays, outbuildings on the west line, no house. Placed on the draw, +100 ft. 1954 USSS single frame, 1.63.000, 2 May 1954. Open range; the draw plain across the north. Placed on the draw, +100 ft. 1965 USSS single frame, 1.21.400, 20 Feb 1965. Still range; a pad at the draw. The bright vertical line is a scratch on the film, not a road. Placed on the draw, +100 ft. 1974 USSS single frame, 1.28.000, 19 Feb 1974. Roads shown and well construction, south half, +150 ft. 1984 USSS NAPP, 28 Oct 1984. Course mature, south half built out. North half still range, +150 ft. 1995 USSS NAPP, 19 Dec 1995. Course mature, south half built out. North half still range, +150 ft. 2024 USGA NAPP, 26 Aug - 9 Sep 2024. Built out to the plot. North half: pads, gathering lines, a caliche yard. Orthomosaic.

CHAIN OF TITLE, 1876-1893 · complete, no gaps

1876. Surveyed 1 Feb by deputy surveyor W.C. Powell, chain carriers L.E. Wright and E.C. Bennett, "on the waters of North Concho." Bearings in varis. Filed at the General Land Office 27 Dec.

1876. Land Scrip No. 3123, 25 May; the Texas & Pacific has built 203 miles, 4,624 feet of railroad. This section is part of what that construction earned. Odd-numbered — railroad land, not school land.

1883. Patented 15 Dec to Texas and Pacific Railway Co. Patent 540, Vol. 68, p. 503, 640 acres.

1906. Charles J. Canda, trustee of the Texas Pacific Land Trust → Mrs. Mary T. Edwards, 640 acres. Recorded 6 Jan, Deed Records 12/54. Three notes of \$795.

1911. Mary T. Edwards and heirs → S.H. Holloway, with Sections 6, 8, 17, 18. Holloway assumes the 1906 notes. Four months later Holloway → S.W. Estes. The Estes years begin.

1921. Armita Estes → Thelma Estes, 7 June. DR 30/144. The whole section; her 1923 deeds of trust cover all 640 acres.

1940. Thelma Estes Brown and W.T. Brown → Magnolia Pipe Line Company, right-of-way across the 640 acres, 2 Dec. DR 67/531. That is the pipeline on the 1954 and 1966 USGS sheets.

1941. Family partition, 31 Oct, four instruments in a row. Thelma Estes Brown → Aldridge Estes. Section 7 (DR 70/294). Aldridge → Thelma, Section 6, the same day. Both had taken land from S.W. and Armita. Kin; the records never say how. Thelma died in 1983 at 80, in Laguna Hills, California.

1953, 1970. Ethel Estes, signing alone; a royalty deed on the 640 acres to Stanolind Oil & Gas, then an oil and gas lease to Pan American Petroleum → Stanolind under its new name. A share of whatever the ground would ever produce, sold before a well existed. When Aldridge died the records do not say; by 1953 she conveyed without him.

1976. Ethel Aldridge Estes → her three children, 14 Dec. DR 615/436-438.

1978. The Estes family sells the surface to Midland West Corporation, 21-22 Nov, three deeds. Price unstated, as Texas deeds are; part of it owed — a deed of trust on the SE/4 secures the developer's note back to Mrs. Estes, so the widow financed the buyer. The minerals stay with the family.

1979. The Estes heirs and Midland West → Pioneer Natural Gas Company, right-of-way, October. DR 673/712-714. The right-of-way today's 16-in ONEOK WestTex gas line runs in.

1979. Midland West, about a dozen partners, opens the Green Tree course in July.

1980-81. Midland West sells lots to Halco Inc. — three warranty deeds, prices unstated, no note back — a Midland homebuilder (incorporated May 1979; Neal Hall, president) that took 771 instruments through this courthouse in five years, buying lots and selling houses. One of those lots lies inside the ground platted the next year, which is why Halco signs the plat.

1982. 8 Jan. Midland West sells 20,343 acres — Lots 20-23, Block 6, the seed of Green Tree North — to The Greens, a joint venture of Halco, Dovecot Inc., and BSD Inc., for \$1,348,425 cash, with a four-year build-or-recover clock and a promise to annex, plat, zone, pave, and pipe the land. DR 731/258.

1982. Green Tree North plat recorded 1 Dec. Cabinet C, p. 134. Frank Mullins becomes majority owner of Midland West the same month.

1983. 26 Jan. the first Green Tree North lot is deeded to a homebuyer — Lot 18, Block 2, from Midland West. DR 770/614. 1 March the members buy the clubhouse and both courses from Midland West for more than \$6 million. Green Tree North — 297 acres, 220 lots, nine more holes — under construction, 85 lots pre-sold, First National Bank of Midland carrying the paper. Three years later a former First National banker is tried in federal court, accused of hiding his own stake in Midland West while the bank lent it \$1.925 million.

1996. Ten acres at the northeast corner of the SE/4 are the family's today; a warranty deed of 9 Aug from one of them to the family's ranch partnership. OR 1400/466. Whether the 1978 deeds carved the corner out or it came back afterward, the index does not show. They are outlined on the map.

The chain stops here. Sixty-seven years of one family; ninety-nine years of open land. Everything since is somebody's home and is not this map's business.

THE GROUND

Water. Ogallala aquifer 100-180 ft below the section. One City of Midland well inside the line, 147 ft, unused. About ten domestic and irrigation wells drilled 2002-2021, 135-180 ft. Golf course well, 175 ft, 2021. Midland Draw crosses the north half and has carried its name on every USGS sheet from 1954 to 2019 — it never disappeared; the ranch did. Powell's 1876 notes call this "waters of North Concho." Modern mapping drains it east to the Colorado by Midland Draw and Beals Creek; the North Concho is not on the path.

Soil. About 60% Amarillo and Midsesa fine sandy loam — well drained, "farmland of statewide importance." Bippus clay loam in the draws, subject to occasional flooding. No hydric soils. Water table below 80 in. A "sandy old farm with one sickly tree and tumbleweeds," as one of the men who bought it remembered it.

Oil. Inside the line, five locations on the Commission's map: Exxon's No. 1 of 1998, still producing; Petroplex's Estes Button 7 No. 3 (2005) and 7-8 Unit No. 4 (2011); one Petroplex permit that expired without a bit turning; and one dry hole with no number on file. Just across the lines, within a thousand feet: a dry hole of December 1980, Henry Resources'; 1208 dry and Fasker's 1208R, producing (2009). Endeavor's Stephens Fee No. 3 (2014, since plugged), two more expired permits, and the toes of three Occidental horizontals — the Easy Target wells, spudded within four days in early 2024 from one pad two and a half miles north in Martin County, 24,000 to 26,000 feet of hole with the last two and a half miles run sideways, stopping a hundred feet short of this section. Their numbers carry Martin County's code, and rightly; against 18,000 permits along this county line, the Commission's code follows the surface hole in every case that could be tested. Seven pipelines cross the section, most of them clipping the northeast corner in one corridor: ONEOK WestTex's 16-in gas line, the full width of the north half, in Pioneer Natural Gas's 1979 right-of-way; Coronado and Sale Ranch gas lines; Roswell East, highly volatile liquids; Mallet-to-Midland 2 and 3, crude; and Oryx's "Green Tree" crude gathering line, T-4 Permit 10611, issued in 2024, the year the pads were drilled. The leases are still named for the family.

Before the streets. Open rangeland on every USGS edition 1954-1985: oil wells, drill holes, a gravel pit, a pipeline. Streets first appear 1991. Built out by 2010.

The course. Summer 1977: two men, one of them the head pro at Ranchland Hills, contract for 320 acres from the Estes family and form Midland West to build a course on it. First National Bank lends the money; those loans end up in federal court. Dirt-trail access into 1980. The course opens July 1979; the members own it from March 1983; the north nine follows; rebuilt 2018.

The measure. Powell called 1,900 varas on every side. The county's polygon measures 1,910 to 1,926. The section holds about 650 acres against 640 patented — ten acres of survey excess that nobody has had to account for in 150 years. And the tilt is not his mistake: all 41 sections of the block run the same 14' off north. The Texas & Pacific laid its blocks on the bearing of the line it meant to build, which crosses this country east-northeast, and Powell's bearings — corrected for the variation he wrote at the head of his notes — match the ground within two degrees. Every street in the neighborhood is square to a railroad that, in 1876, was still two hundred miles away.

COULD NOT BE CONFIRMED

Compiled from records, not walked. The following were looked for and not found, or found and not trusted:

- One dry hole, Well No. 1, plotted from the Commission's hardcopy map with no API number on file. Its operator and date are in no digital record.
- What the first lot sold for. A course-front lot was asking \$55,000 that winter; the first deed of trust is indexed at a figure too small to believe.
- Where on the ranch the calves of 1916 and the reunion of 1921 were. Not on this section, which had no house in 1946; which of the family's other sections is not known.
- If you know any of these, write. Second edition is free to anyone who corrects the first.

Sources. Texas General Land Office (patent, field notes, scrip); Midland County Clerk (deed records as cited); Midland Central Appraisal District (abstracts, parcels); USGS topoView and EarthExplorer (topographic sheets 1954-2019, features from the 1966 Northwest Midland 7.5' sheet; aerials 1954, 1965, 1974, 1984, 1995); WellWiki, ezrc, and texas-drilling mirrors of RRC permit and completion data; Midland Reporter-Telegram 1950-1999 via the Southwest Collection, Texas Tech University; Texas Comptroller entry records; USGA 1946 aerials, frames 67-68 (TIGTO); USGA NAPP 2024 (quarter quads of 26 Aug and 9 Sep 2024, via USGS EarthExplorer); Railroad Commission of Texas GIS and 2024 T-4 permit register; Texas Water Development Board; USDA-NRCS Web Soil Survey; EPA WATERS / NHDPlus; federal court records as cited. Full source log, fifty-plus rows, at github.com/acw188/One-square-mile.

Gathered by Skippy (Meta Muse). Designed by Claude (Anthropic). Approved and paid for by a resident of the section, who is not named on it. No phone calls were made. Sheet oriented to the 1876 survey; true north 15' right of page-up. Scale 1:3,000. Aerial strip: each frame's placement error is sized in its caption.